Card Dispute and Chargeback SOP

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1. Purpose

This SOP defines how card_ops and customer_support handle disputes raised by cardholders of Aspire corporate cards, from intake to chargeback and representment. It supports the Visa and Mastercard dispute processes summarised in the internal Scheme Rules Summary (K03).

2. Intake

• Customer support logs the dispute in SupportDesk under category CARD-DISP within 1 business day of the customer contact, capturing transaction ID, amount, merchant, date and reason.

• Dispute eligibility window: the cardholder must raise the dispute within 120 days of the transaction date (or of the expected delivery date for goods and services not received). Aspire's chargeback window to the network is 120 days from the transaction processing date.

• Disputes of amounts below SGD 15 are not charged back unless part of a fraud pattern.

3. Reason Code Groups

Group	Aspire code	Description	Key evidence
Fraud	FR1	Card-present or online transaction not authorised	Cardholder statement, card status, device and 3DS logs
Authorisation	AU1	Transaction processed without authorisation or above approved amount	Authorisation log
Processing	PR1	Duplicate charge, incorrect amount or currency	Both transaction records, receipts
Merchandise	MS1	Goods or services not received or not as described	Order confirmation, correspondence with merchant, cancellation proof
Cancelled	CN1	Recurring billing after cancellation	Cancellation date and confirmation
Credit not processed	CR1	Refund promised but not received	Refund promise or return receipt

4. Evidence Windows

• Cardholder evidence request: sent within 1 business day of intake; customer has 10 calendar days to respond. No response closes the case with notification.

• Fraud claims: cardholder must sign the fraud declaration within 5 business days; card is blocked and reissued immediately.

• Chargeback submission: card_ops must file within 30 calendar days of receiving complete evidence, and never later than day 120.

• Merchant representment response period from the network: 30 calendar days.

5. Provisional Credit

For fraud claims (FR1) with a completed declaration and no indicators of first-party fraud, provisional credit is applied to the cardholder account within 5 business days of the claim. Provisional credit is reversed if the dispute is later found invalid, with 10 days notice to the customer. Non-fraud disputes do not receive provisional credit unless approved by the card_ops Team Lead for amounts below SGD 2,000.

6. Chargeback Filing

• Card_ops files the chargeback through the scheme dispute platform with the correct reason code, narrative and evidence pack.

• Fraud (FR1): attach the signed declaration, authorisation and 3DS logs, and card status history.

• Merchandise (MS1): attach order proof, customer-merchant correspondence and evidence that the customer tried to resolve the issue with the merchant.

• Case reference and chargeback ID are recorded in SupportDesk, and the customer is updated within 2 business days of filing.

7. Representment Handling

When the merchant bank represents the item, card_ops reviews the rebuttal within 5 business days. Steps: (1) compare the merchant evidence with the original claim; (2) contact the customer for a response within 5 days; (3) accept the representment and re-debit the customer if evidence is valid; or (4) decline and escalate to pre-arbitration within 10 calendar days if evidence is inadequate. Pre-arbitration cases above SGD 5,000 require Team Lead approval. Arbitration is a last resort and requires approval from the Head of Card Operations because scheme fees can reach USD 500 per case.

8. Service Levels and Controls

• Acknowledge dispute to customer: 1 business day.

• Final decision on non-complex disputes: 45 days from intake.

• Chargeback win-rate target: at least 60%; fraud write-off below 4 bps of card volume.

• Daily reconciliation of provisional credits; weekly ageing report of cases beyond 90 days sent to the Head of Card Operations.